MAJORS

League age 11 and 12 | 12" ball | 40 ft pitching | All-Stars age

The full game of Little League softball. Girls pitch from 40 feet, runners can leave when the pitch is released, and the dropped third strike is in play.

PURPOSE PROPOSAL

Majors is where girls play the full game and learn to play as a team: knowing the situation, talking on defense, and sharing the pitching. Every girl should finish the season better at a position she can play in Juniors.

Winning is part of Majors. Every girl still plays, and no girl's arm is risked to win a game.

GAME RULES THAT CHANGE COACHING RULE

- Every girl plays at least 6 defensive outs. Continuous batting order.
- Runners can leave the base when the pitcher releases the ball.
- The dropped third strike is in play.
- Courtesy runner for the pitcher or catcher when there are 2 outs.
- A girl can pitch in up to 12 innings a day. One pitch counts as an inning. 7 or more innings means a day of rest.
- Up to 3 coaches on the field. A team can play with 8, but the 9th spot in the order is an out.
- No new inning after 2 hours 30 minutes. Weekday games start at 6:00 pm.

FOCUS SKILLS PROPOSAL

1. **Pitcher.** Strikes with the fastball first, then a change-up as the second pitch.
2. **Catcher.** Blocking balls in the dirt, throwing to second on a steal, covering home.
3. **Team defense.** Bunt coverage, covering bases on a steal, cutoffs and relays, the dropped third strike.
4. **Hitting.** A plan for each count, and a sacrifice bunt.
5. **Running the bases.** Leaving on the release, stealing, running on a dropped third strike.

BY THE END OF THE SEASON PROPOSAL

- Every team has at least 3 girls who can pitch 2 innings for strikes.
- Every girl knows her job on a bunt and on a steal.
- Every girl can put down a sacrifice bunt.
- Every catcher can throw to second base.
- Every girl has played a position she could play in Juniors.

NOT ENOUGH, TOO MUCH PROPOSAL

NOT ENOUGH

- One girl pitches most of the innings all season.
- No practice time on bunt coverage or steals.
- Girls play the same single position all season.
- The strongest 9 play all game and the rest get the bare minimum every time.

TOO MUCH

- Pitching a girl right up to the daily innings limit.
- Adding pitches before her fastball and change-up are strikes.
- More than 3 team practices a week.
- Coaching every pitch from the dugout during games.

A 90-MINUTE PRACTICE PROPOSAL

- **Positions:** pitchers and catchers together, infield and outfield work.
- **Team defense:** bunts, steals, cutoffs, the dropped third strike.
- **Live hitting:** against your own pitchers, with runners on base.

COACH'S ROLE PROPOSAL

- Track every girl's innings pitched and build at least 3 pitchers.
- Teach the why behind each play so girls make their own decisions.
- Tell parents at the first meeting how playing time and pitching will work, before the first close game.

Draft. Blue = rule. Gold = proposal the softball committee has not approved yet.